



“PETROL, DIESEL AND EVs WILL BE PRICED EQUALLY SOON”

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Nitin Gadkari, Minister for Road Transport and Highways, on reducing the dependence on petroleum imports, the next phase of growth and more

BY SIDDHARTH ZARABI

WHEN INDIA TURNS 100 as a republic in 2047, the story of its progress will also be that of its roads. And few have built more of them than Nitin Gadkari. For over a decade as Minister for Road Transport and Highways, he has been the architect of a national transformation measured in expressways, bridges,

tunnels, and the sheer audacity of connecting a nation of 1.4 billion people. Launching *Business Today's* special *India@100* edition, a blueprint of 100 bold reforms for the next quarter-century, Gadkari spoke about what is next on the road map, and how fast India can get there. Edited excerpts:

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What will India's roads and highways look like in 2047?

When I became minister, I had a quote by American President John F. Kennedy written and placed in my office in front of my table—*American roads are not good because America is rich, but America is rich because American roads are good.* We started work

with this in mind. I will not list old work because you know that already. But just in Delhi NCR, we are working on projects worth ₹1 lakh crore. In the next four months, we will award new projects worth ₹40,000 crore again.

This year, we have two targets. These are targets, not declarations. The first is that from building 38 km of road per day we

